

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY — SAMPLE SUPERSTORE ANALYSIS

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Executive Summary

An analysis of the Sample Superstore dataset shows that Technology and Office Supplies serve as consistent, high-margin revenue drivers, while Furniture — despite strong sales volume — materially drags on overall profitability, converting sales at roughly half the company-average margin. This erosion is concentrated in aggressively discounted sub-categories, most notably Tables, where discounts of 40%+ routinely push orders into negative profit.

Geographically, the West and East regions lead in both sales and profit, while Central and South lag on margin. With a significant share of order lines loss-making, the findings point to one clear priority: revise the discount strategy — particularly for Furniture — and shift promotional focus toward high-margin Technology and Office Supplies lines to protect and grow the bottom line.

Key Findings

1. Furniture carries high sales but the weakest margin; Tables is the single largest loss driver.
2. Negative-profit orders cluster at discounts $\geq 40\%$.
3. West & East generate the majority of profit; Central & South trail on margin.
4. 1,871 order lines (18.7%) sell below cost.

Recommendations

1. Cap discounts (30–40% max; stricter for Furniture/Tables).
2. Reprice or review shipping costs on loss-making sub-categories.
3. Reallocate promotional spend toward Technology & Office Supplies; monitor regional margins monthly.

Business Questions asked for each Pivot Tables

1. *Which categories generate the most revenue, and which are actually profitable?*
2. *How do sales and profits compare across different geographic regions?*
3. *Which specific product sub-categories are losing the company money?*
4. *Which customer segments drive the most sales, and what shipping modes do they prefer?*
5. *What are the trends for profit and sales for each month ?*

Summary Tab Snapshot

Strategy: *(Synthesizes the findings into a clear narrative and actionable business recommendations.)*

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY — SAMPLE SUPERSTORE ANALYSIS					
Prepared by: Prasanna Shetty · Source: SampleSuperstore.csv · Date: 12-09-2026					
Total Sales	Total Profit	Profit Margin	Loss Making Orders	Loss Rate	Furniture Margin
\$22,97,201	\$2,86,397	12.5%	1,871	3.1%	2.5%
Executive Summary					
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Key Findings					
1. Furniture carries high sales but the weakest margin; Tables is the single largest loss driver (Pivot 3). 2. Negative-profit orders cluster at discounts $\geq 40\%$ (Pivot 4 / Working tab). 3. West & East generate the majority of profit; Central & South trail on margin (Pivot 2). 4. 1871 order lines 3.1% sell below cost (KPI strip).					
Recommendations					
1. Cap discounts ($\approx 30\text{--}40\%$ max; stricter for Furniture/Tables). 2. Reprice or review shipping costs on loss-making sub-categories. 3. Reallocate promotional spend toward Technology & Office Supplies; monitor regional margins monthly.					
All figures auto-update from the Raw Data tab (n = 9,994 order lines).					

KPI Dashboard Breakdown

Health : *(Provides a quick pulse-check on the overarching metrics and flags the alarming loss rate.)*

KPI DASHBOARD — SUPERSTORE	
GLOBAL KPIs	
Total Sales	\$22,97,200.86
Total Profit	\$2,86,397.02
Total Quantity Sold	37,873
Total Order Count	9,994
Unprofitable Orders	1,871
TARGETED METRICS	
Sales -- Technology	\$8,36,154.03
Profit -- West Region	\$1,08,418.45
Avg Discount -- Furniture	17.4%
Sales -- Customer Segment	\$11,61,401.34
RATIOS (bonus)	
Profit Margin %	12.5%
Loss Rate %	18.7%

Pivot Tables & Analysis

Performance :*(Breaks down the data by category, region, and segment to expose exactly where the profit leaks are happening.)*

1 Category				4 Segment x Ship Mode							
Revenue & Profitability by Category				Segment x Ship Mode							
Category	Sum of Sales	Sum of Profit		Ship Mode	Values						
Technology	\$8,36,154	\$1,45,455		First Class	Same Day	Second Class	Standard Class				
Furniture	\$7,42,000	\$18,451		Sum of Sales	Sales % of Seg Sum of Sales	Sales % of Segment	Sum of Sales	Sales % of Segment	Sum of Sales	Sales %	
Office Supplies	\$7,19,047	\$1,22,491		Consumer	\$1,59,169	13.7%	\$60,596	5.2%	\$2,31,499	19.9%	\$7,10,137
Grand Total	\$22,97,201	\$2,86,397		Corporate	\$1,05,858	15.0%	\$45,121	6.4%	\$1,46,126	20.7%	\$4,09,041
				Home Office	\$86,401	20.1%	\$22,645	5.3%	\$81,569	19.0%	\$2,39,038
				Grand Total	\$3,51,428	15.3%	\$1,28,363	5.6%	\$4,59,194	20.0%	\$13,58,216
2 Region											
Regional Performance											
Region	Sum of Sales	Sum of Profit	Sum of Margin %								
West	\$7,25,458	\$1,08,418	14.9%								
East	\$6,78,781	\$91,523	13.5%								
Central	\$5,01,240	\$39,706	7.9%								
South	\$3,91,722	\$46,749	11.9%								
Grand Total	\$22,97,201	\$2,86,397	12.5%								
3 Sub-Category loss leaders				5 Month trend							
Loss Leaders: Sub-Category deep dive				Sales & Profit trend by Month							
Category	Sub-Category	Sum of Profit	Sum of Sales	Order Date	Sum of Sales	Sum of Profit					
Furniture	Bookcases	-\$3,473	\$1,14,880	1/1/2017	\$1,482	-\$181					
	Chairs	\$26,590	\$3,28,449	1/10/2014	\$55	\$23					
	Furnishings	\$13,059	\$91,705	1/10/2015	\$1,018	-\$373					
	Tables	-\$17,725	\$2,06,966	1/10/2016	\$175	\$55					
				1/11/2014	\$10	\$3					
				1/11/2016	\$149	\$25					
				1/12/2015	\$855	\$63					

Raw Data Source

Foundation :*(Represents the raw, row-level transactional data that powers the entire analysis.)*

A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M	N	O	P	Q
Row ID	Order ID	Order Date	Ship Date	Ship Mode	Customer ID	Customer Name	Segment	Country	City	State	Postal Code	Region	Product ID	Category	Sub-Category	Product
1	CA-2016-152156	11/8/2016	11/11/2016	Second Class	CG-12520	Claire Gute	Consumer	United States	Henderson	Kentucky	42420	South	FUR-BO-10001798	Furniture	Bookcases	Bush S
2	CA-2016-152156	11/8/2016	11/11/2016	Second Class	CG-12520	Claire Gute	Consumer	United States	Henderson	Kentucky	42420	South	FUR-CH-10000454	Furniture	Chairs	Hon De
3	CA-2016-138688	6/12/2016	6/16/2016	Second Class	DV-13045	Darrin Van Huff	Corporate	United States	Los Angeles	California	90036	West	OFF-LA-10000240	Office Supplies	Labels	Self-Ad
4	US-2015-108966	10/11/2015	10/18/2015	Standard Class	SO-20335	Sean O'Donnell	Consumer	United States	Fort Lauderdale	Florida	33311	South	FUR-TA-10000577	Furniture	Tables	Bretfor
5	US-2015-108966	10/11/2015	10/18/2015	Standard Class	SO-20335	Sean O'Donnell	Consumer	United States	Fort Lauderdale	Florida	33311	South	OFF-ST-10000760	Office Supplies	Storage	Eldon f
6	CA-2014-115812	6/9/2014	6/14/2014	Standard Class	BH-11710	Brosina Hoffman	Consumer	United States	Los Angeles	California	90032	West	FUR-FU-10001487	Furniture	Furnishings	Eldon f
7	CA-2014-115812	6/9/2014	6/14/2014	Standard Class	BH-11710	Brosina Hoffman	Consumer	United States	Los Angeles	California	90032	West	OFF-AR-10002833	Office Supplies	Art	Newell
8	CA-2014-115812	6/9/2014	6/14/2014	Standard Class	BH-11710	Brosina Hoffman	Consumer	United States	Los Angeles	California	90032	West	TEC-PH-10002275	Technology	Phones	Mitel 5
9	CA-2014-115812	6/9/2014	6/14/2014	Standard Class	BH-11710	Brosina Hoffman	Consumer	United States	Los Angeles	California	90032	West	OFF-BI-10003910	Office Supplies	Binders	DXL Ar
10	CA-2014-115812	6/9/2014	6/14/2014	Standard Class	BH-11710	Brosina Hoffman	Consumer	United States	Los Angeles	California	90032	West	OFF-AP-10002892	Office Supplies	Appliances	Belkin
11	CA-2014-115812	6/9/2014	6/14/2014	Standard Class	BH-11710	Brosina Hoffman	Consumer	United States	Los Angeles	California	90032	West	FUR-TA-10001539	Furniture	Tables	Chrom
12	CA-2014-115812	6/9/2014	6/14/2014	Standard Class	BH-11710	Brosina Hoffman	Consumer	United States	Los Angeles	California	90032	West	TEC-PH-10002033	Technology	Phones	Konfte
13	CA-2017-114412	4/15/2017	4/20/2017	Standard Class	AA-10480	Andrew Allen	Consumer	United States	Concord	North Carolina	28027	South	OFF-PA-10002365	Office Supplies	Paper	Xerox:
14	CA-2016-161385	12/5/2016	12/10/2016	Standard Class	IM-15070	Irene Maddox	Consumer	United States	Seattle	Washington	98103	West	OFF-BI-10003656	Office Supplies	Binders	Fellow
15	US-2015-118983	11/22/2015	11/26/2015	Standard Class	HP-14815	Harold Pawlan	Home Office	United States	Fort Worth	Texas	76106	Central	OFF-AP-10002311	Office Supplies	Appliances	Holme
16	US-2015-118983	11/22/2015	11/26/2015	Standard Class	HP-14815	Harold Pawlan	Home Office	United States	Fort Worth	Texas	76106	Central	OFF-BI-10000756	Office Supplies	Binders	Storex
17	CA-2014-105893	11/13/2014	11/18/2014	Standard Class	PK-19075	Pete Kriz	Consumer	United States	Madison	Wisconsin	53711	Central	OFF-BI-10004186	Office Supplies	Storage	Store-D
18	CA-2014-167164	5/13/2014	5/15/2014	Second Class	AG-10270	Alejandro Grove	Consumer	United States	West Jordan	Utah	84084	West	OFF-ST-10000107	Office Supplies	Storage	Fellow
19	CA-2014-143336	8/27/2014	9/1/2014	Second Class	ZD-21925	Zuschuss Donatelli	Consumer	United States	San Francisco	California	94109	West	OFF-AR-10003056	Office Supplies	Art	Newell
20	CA-2014-143336	8/27/2014	9/1/2014	Second Class	ZD-21925	Zuschuss Donatelli	Consumer	United States	San Francisco	California	94109	West	TEC-PH-10001949	Technology	Phones	Cisco S
21	CA-2014-143336	8/27/2014	9/1/2014	Second Class	ZD-21925	Zuschuss Donatelli	Consumer	United States	San Francisco	California	94109	West	OFF-BI-10002215	Office Supplies	Binders	Wilson
22	CA-2016-13733C	12/9/2016	12/13/2016	Standard Class	KB-16585	Ken Black	Corporate	United States	Fremont	Nebraska	68025	Central	OFF-AR-10000246	Office Supplies	Art	Newell
23	CA-2016-13733C	12/9/2016	12/13/2016	Standard Class	KB-16585	Ken Black	Corporate	United States	Fremont	Nebraska	68025	Central	OFF-AP-10001492	Office Supplies	Appliances	Acco S
24	US-2017-156905	7/16/2017	7/18/2017	Second Class	SF-20065	Sandra Flanagan	Consumer	United States	Philadelphia	Pennsylvania	19140	East	FUR-CH-10002774	Furniture	Chairs	Global
25	CA-2015-10632C	9/25/2015	9/30/2015	Standard Class	EB-13870	Emily Burns	Consumer	United States	Orem	Utah	84057	West	FUR-TA-10000577	Furniture	Tables	Bretfor
26	CA-2016-121755	1/16/2016	1/20/2016	Second Class	EH-13945	Eric Hoffmann	Consumer	United States	Los Angeles	California	90049	West	OFF-BI-10001634	Office Supplies	Binders	Wilson
27	CA-2016-121755	1/16/2016	1/20/2016	Second Class	EH-13945	Eric Hoffmann	Consumer	United States	Los Angeles	California	90049	West	TEC-AC-10003027	Technology	Accessories	Imatio
28	US-2015-15063C	9/17/2015	9/21/2015	Standard Class	TB-21520	Tracy Blumstein	Consumer	United States	Philadelphia	Pennsylvania	19140	East	FUR-BO-10004834	Furniture	Bookcases	Riversi
29	US-2015-15063C	9/17/2015	9/21/2015	Standard Class	TB-21520	Tracy Blumstein	Consumer	United States	Philadelphia	Pennsylvania	19140	East	OFF-BI-10000474	Office Supplies	Binders	Avery I
30	US-2015-15063C	9/17/2015	9/21/2015	Standard Class	TB-21520	Tracy Blumstein	Consumer	United States	Philadelphia	Pennsylvania	19140	East	FUR-FU-10004848	Furniture	Furnishings	Howar
31	US-2015-15063C	9/17/2015	9/21/2015	Standard Class	TB-21520	Tracy Blumstein	Consumer	United States	Philadelphia	Pennsylvania	19140	East	OFF-EN-10001509	Office Supplies	Envelopes	Poly St